

FREE LIGHTNING LESSON · 45 MINUTES



# How to Tell If Your Career Is Stalling

Three signs your role may have stopped building your skills and future options, even while you are performing well.

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A CAPABILITY FORMATION LIGHTNING LESSON

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WELCOME

# Why I Built This Lesson

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**Temidayo Afonja — Career Portability Advisor.  
Founder, The Density Group.  
Author, The Capability Audit.**

My career has moved through accounting and audit, cybersecurity, people strategy, employee experience and enterprise transformation, across multiple industries and sectors.

That journey made me interested in a different career question:

**What remains useful when the context changes?**

In 2026, the question became personal.

**“Can a career begin to stall while the person is still performing well?”**



# What Today Will Help You Do

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## **1 SPOT THE PATTERN**

Recognize which of three career-stall patterns may deserve attention.

## **2 TEST IT AGAINST RECENT WORK**

Use one example from the last 90 days rather than a title, promise or feeling.

## **3 NAME THE NEXT QUESTION**

Identify what deserves closer examination before a bigger move.

### **TODAY WILL NOT:**

**tell you whether to stay or leave**

**place you in a Career State**

**make a personalized employment decision**

# What brought you here today?

Choose the closest reason.

Promotion or larger role

Reorganization or role change

Internal move decision

Will my experience travel?

My role feels static

AI, layoffs or restructuring

## THE CENTRAL INSIGHT

# A Role Can Reward You Long After It Stops Building You

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Strong performance may tell you that you are delivering value.

It does not, by itself, tell you whether the work is still:

- Expanding your judgment
- Exposing you to unfamiliar problems
- Building capability that travels
- Increasing your future options

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***Performance matters. It is not the whole picture.***

# A pivot does not mean everything transfers.

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## WHAT MAY TRAVEL

**Judgment**  
**Problem framing**  
**Evidence**  
**Systems thinking**  
**Risk recognition**  
**Stakeholder trust**  
**Ways of solving unfamiliar problems**

## WHAT DOES NOT TRAVEL AUTOMATICALLY

**Industry language**  
**Regulation**  
**Technical frameworks**  
**Internal systems**  
**Relationships**  
**Operating context**

**Starting as a learner is not the same as starting from zero.**

## SIGN 1

# You Are Repeating, Not Stretching

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**You may be performing at a high level, but the work is no longer asking you to solve meaningfully unfamiliar problems.**

### THE TEST

***What problem have you solved in the last 90 days that you genuinely did not already know how to solve?***

**QUICK CHECK** - live in the chat or in your own note

***In one word, is your recent work stretching, repeating, or unclear?***

## SIGN 2

# You Are Indispensable, but Mainly Here

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**The organization relies on you, but your value may be increasingly tied to its systems, internal language, relationships, processes, or history.**

### THE TEST

*Could someone outside your company explain your value without using your title or internal company language?*

### QUICK CHECK

*Which has grown fastest: internal dependence, external visibility, or both?*



## SIGN 3

# Your Responsibility Is Growing Faster Than Your Capability

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**Your title, scope, and expectations may be increasing while the range of judgment, unfamiliar problems, or transferable capability being formed in you is narrowing.**

### THE TEST

*What capability do you have now that you did not have before your responsibilities increased?*

### QUICK CHECK

*Which has grown faster: responsibility, learning, or visibility?*

# Five quiet minutes.

Use a notebook, notes app, or the Career Stall Check if you already have it.

1

**Which sign is most present for me?**

Repeating instead of stretching, indispensable but mainly here, or responsibility growing faster than capability.

2

**What is one example from the last 90 days?**

Use a lived example, not a plan, promise, title, or feeling.

3

**What capability, learning, or future option may not be growing?**

Name the specific thing, not a general sense that something is off.

4

**What is the next question I need to investigate?**

The question you would need to read more carefully before making a bigger career decision.

# A recognition exercise is not a result.

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- If one sign felt familiar, that does not mean you should leave.
  - If none felt familiar, that does not mean your role is still building you.
  - **RECOGNITION TELLS YOU:** what may deserve examination.
  - **ASSESSMENT TELLS YOU:** what your evidence can support more defensibly.
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*As routine output becomes easier to reproduce, the distinction between familiar performance and growing judgment becomes more consequential.*

# The Risk of Acting on One Signal

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## Leaving too quickly

May mean giving up internal equity, relationships, flexibility, compensation or momentum before testing whether another context inside the organization could solve the problem.

## Staying too long

May narrow learning, external visibility and future options if the role continues relying on what you already know.

**Recognition tells you what to examine.**

Evidence helps you decide what to test next.

# **Today helped you spot the pattern. September 16 helps you read the position.**

## **TODAY: RECOGNITION**

**Name one pattern you can see.**

**Point to one recent example.**

**Identify one question worth investigating.**

## **SEPTEMBER 16: GUIDED READ**

**Complete an initial and evidence-backed reading.**

**Record a provisional position, boundary or incomplete reading.**

**Choose one category of move worth testing.**

**Write your Next-Move Note.**

**FREE · 60 MINUTES · 6:00 PM CT**

**September 2 opens the question. September 16 guides the read.**

# Join me live, or continue privately.

## FREE LIVE SESSION

### Stay or Leave? Live Career Growth Assessment

Wednesday, September 16, 2026

6:00 PM CT · 60 minutes

**Complete the guided reading with me.**

REGISTER FREE

[maven.com/p/8b3c40/  
stay-or-leave-live-career-growth-assessment](https://maven.com/p/8b3c40/stay-or-leave-live-career-growth-assessment)



## \$150 · SELF-GUIDED · RERUN QUARTERLY

### Capability Formation Field Kit

**A private, repeatable evidence system you can own, revisit and rerun as conditions change.**

EXPLORE THE FIELD KIT

[temidayoafonja.com/fieldkit](https://temidayoafonja.com/fieldkit)



**Neither route is required. September 16 is free. The Field Kit is optional and private.**

# Ten minutes for questions.

Questions about the ideas are welcome. Individual situations will not be scored or diagnosed in this room.

1

## Good questions to explore

How do I tell the difference between performance and formation? What does portability mean? What kind of evidence counts?

2

## Questions to redirect

Should I leave? What state am I in? What should I do about my manager? Can you score my situation?

3

## Boundary line

I can help you clarify what the pattern suggests examining. I cannot make the employment decision for you.

Continue live on September 16 or privately with the Field Kit · Links in chat